

Final Project Checkpoint 3: Preliminary Analysis

DUE December 8 at 5 PM

To complete this assignment, you must have your data inspected. You will write a three-page memo describing your data. Depending on your topic and how you measure your variables, the best way to summarize your data will vary, but you should at a minimum provide the following information:

- The appropriate measures of central tendency (mean/median/mode) of each variable.
- Measures of dispersion for each variable.
- A measure of association (correlation, cross-tab, etc.) describing the relationship between your main dependent variable and key independent variable(s).
- A bivariate hypothesis test evaluating the relationship between your main dependent variable and key independent variable(s).
- At least one figure (histogram, scatterplot, etc.) that helps the reader to visualize the data for your key variables.

This assignment should be written in paragraph form and no R code should be copy/pasted in the memo. You can use the “Data” sections of some of the articles we have read in class as examples.

To be clear, this is a different type of “paper” than you may have written before. You don’t need a thesis. Your task is simply to plainly describe the data and what seems interesting about it.

Please print your hypothesis in bold at the top of your submission!

Grading Rubric (2 Points)

Central Tendency (0.4 Points): Includes appropriate measures of central tendency (mean/median/mode) for the dependent and main independent variables. Demonstrates clear understanding of these statistics.

- Only mean is enough for continuous variables.
- Median and mode are enough for categorical variables.

Dispersion (0.4 Points): Includes measures dispersion for the dependent and main independent variables. Demonstrates clear understanding of these statistics.

- Only range and standard deviation (or variance) are enough.

Measure of Association (0.4 Points): Provides a relevant measure of association (e.g., correlation or cross-tab) and conducts an appropriate bivariate hypothesis test. Results should be correctly interpreted in light of the hypothesis.

Bivariate Hypothesis Test (0.4 Points): Conducts an appropriate bivariate hypothesis test. Results should be correctly interpreted in light of the hypothesis.

Visualization (0.2 Points): Includes at least one clear and relevant figure (e.g., histogram, scatterplot) to visualize one or both of the key variables.

Formatting (0.2 Points): Hypothesis is clearly stated in bold at the top of the submission.